

Investing in Women Farmers

■350,000 in Agricultural Grants Supporting 11 Female Farmers in Obiaruku, Ukwuani LGA, Delta State — IWD 2024: Invest in Women: Accelerate Progress

In commemoration of International Women's Day 2024, Girls for Development Goals Foundation distributed ■350,000 in in-kind agricultural grants to 11 women farmers in Obiaruku, Ukwuani LGA, Delta State. Ten women received pesticides and containers (Pulse brand 16L knapsack sprayers and agro-chemicals) and one received seedlings — directly supporting their livelihoods and strengthening food security in their communities.

Organisation	Girls for Development Goals Foundation (GDGF)
Date	March 2024 — International Women's Day 2024
IWD 2024 Theme	Invest in Women: Accelerate Progress
Location	Obiaruku, Ukwuani LGA, Delta State, Nigeria
Beneficiaries	11 women farmers
Total Grant Value	■350,000
Grant per beneficiary	~■31,818 average per woman
Items distributed	10 women: Pulse 16L knapsack sprayers + pesticides/agro-chemicals · 1 woman: seedlings
Purpose	Sustain livelihoods · strengthen food security · recognise women's role in agriculture





Eleven women farmers in Obiaruku receiving in-kind agricultural grants from GDGF, March 2024. Pulse brand 16L knapsack sprayers (boxes) and agricultural chemicals visible. GDGF banner: 'Commemorates International Women's Day — Supporting Female Farmers in Obiaruku, Delta State.' Total grant value: ₦350,000.

Overview

In commemoration of International Women's Day 2024, under the UN theme 'Invest in Women: Accelerate Progress,' Girls for Development Goals Foundation distributed ₦350,000 in in-kind agricultural grants to 11 women farmers in Obiaruku, Ukwuani LGA, Delta State, Nigeria. The initiative recognised women's foundational role in Nigerian agriculture and translated the IWD theme into direct, practical action — investing in the tools and inputs women farmers need to sustain and grow their livelihoods.

Ten women received pesticides and containers — Pulse brand 16-litre knapsack sprayers and agricultural chemicals — enabling them to manage and protect their crops effectively. One woman received seedlings to support her planting activities. At an average of approximately ₦31,818 per beneficiary, each grant was precisely calibrated to provide a complete, usable agricultural input package. All 11 beneficiaries expressed deep gratitude, confirming the support helped sustain their livelihoods and strengthened food security in their communities.

IWD 2024 theme alignment: 'Invest in Women: Accelerate Progress' calls for tangible investments in women's economic participation. Providing ₦350,000 in agricultural grants to 11 women farmers is precisely this — a direct, documented investment in productivity, income, and food security, delivered on International Women's Day.

Context — Women in Nigerian Agriculture

Women make up between 60 and 80 percent of Nigeria's agricultural labour force, playing a crucial role in food production, processing, and distribution. Despite this central contribution, women farmers consistently face greater barriers to accessing agricultural inputs, equipment, land, credit, and extension services than their male counterparts.

The gap GDGF addressed: Women contribute the majority of Nigeria's agricultural labour yet are systematically underserved by agricultural support systems. Access to pesticides, sprayers, and quality seedlings is the difference between a crop lost to pests and a harvest that feeds a family and generates income. GDGF's ₦350,000 grant programme addressed this gap directly in its founding community.

Obiaruku, Ukwuani LGA is GDGF's home community — where the Foundation held its inaugural Campaign Against Teenage Pregnancy in December 2016. Returning to Obiaruku in 2024 to support women farmers reflects a long-term commitment to the community where GDGF began.

Grant Distribution

10 Women — Pesticides and Containers (Pulse 16L Knapsack Sprayers)

Ten women farmers received Pulse brand 16-litre knapsack sprayers and agricultural pesticide/chemical inputs — a complete package enabling them to apply crop protection products across their farms. This directly addresses one of the most significant threats to smallholder crop yields: pest and disease loss from inadequate or inaccessible crop protection.

Why this package: A knapsack sprayer without chemicals is unusable; chemicals without an application tool are equally so. GDGF's grant provided both — a complete, immediately deployable crop protection solution at approximately ₦31,818 per woman.

1 Woman — Seedlings

One woman farmer received seedlings to support her planting activities — quality planting material being the foundational input that determines a crop's potential from the start of every growing season.

Financial Summary

Category	Details
Total grant value	₦350,000
Number of beneficiaries	11 women farmers
Average grant per beneficiary	~₦31,818
Grant type	In-kind (agricultural inputs purchased and distributed directly)
10 grants	Pulse 16L knapsack sprayers + pesticides/agro-chemicals
1 grant	Seedlings
Location	Obiaruku, Ukwuani LGA, Delta State

Outcomes and Impact

■350,000 invested directly in 11 women farmers

Each beneficiary received agricultural inputs with an average value of approximately ■31,818 — a meaningful, practical investment in a smallholder farmer's productive capacity.

Livelihoods sustained

All 11 beneficiaries confirmed the support helped sustain their livelihoods. For women farming in Ukwuani LGA, whose incomes depend directly on crop yields, this is a documented livelihood impact.

Food security strengthened in Obiaruku

By equipping women farmers to protect and grow their crops, the initiative directly contributed to household and community food security — women who farm more produce more food for their families.

IWD 2024 theme operationalised

'Invest in Women: Accelerate Progress' was delivered not as a seminar but as ■350,000 of agricultural equipment and inputs, handed to 11 women in their community. That is what the theme demands.

GDGF's mandate expanded into agricultural livelihoods

This initiative marks GDGF's first documented agricultural livelihoods grant programme — expanding the Foundation's scope into the economic foundations that underpin women's and girls' wellbeing.

Return to GDGF's founding community

Eight years after GDGF's first programme in Obiaruku, the Foundation returned to support women farmers — demonstrating sustained commitment to the community where it began.

Initiative Summary

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1 grant	Seedlings
Primary outcomes	Sustained livelihoods · strengthened community food security
Significance	GDGF's first agricultural livelihoods grant programme · return to founding community

Learning and Recommendations

This ₦350,000 initiative established a new programme category for GDGF — agricultural livelihoods grants. A recurring annual IWD agricultural grant programme, growing in scale, would build a compelling portfolio for gender-responsive agricultural development funders.

Documenting post-distribution outcomes — what was grown, what was harvested, what income was generated — would strengthen future grant applications significantly. Even brief follow-up 3–6 months post-distribution creates impact evidence funders value.

The Pulse knapsack sprayer + chemicals package proved a complete, deployable crop protection solution for smallholder farmers. This input bundle should be standardised as a recurring grant unit for future editions.

Expanding to more women per edition and documenting total investment value — as now established — enables year-on-year comparison and trend reporting.

Acknowledgements

- The 11 women farmers of Obiaruku, Ukwuani LGA — for their daily contribution to food production and their community's food security
- Girls for Development Goals Foundation team — for returning to the Foundation's founding community to deliver this initiative

References

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